

## Major suit raises

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Major suit bids. The Major suits are Hearts and Spades.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

you need 26 points to make game (4♥ 4♠)

you need 33 points to make slam (6♥ 6♠)

open 1♥ or 1♠ with 13-21 points at least five of the suit

respond by raising to 2-level with 6-10 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 3-level with 11-12 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 13-16 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 8-12 points and at least five of the suit

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 1♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦3

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣A

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥9

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♣A

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 9 2  
♥ 8 5 3  
♦ A J 10 2  
♣ K 9

♠ A 5

♥ K Q 10 9 7

♦ K Q 6

♣ Q J 4



♠ Q 8 4

♥ A 6

♦ 8 5 3

♣ A 10 7 3 2

♠ K 7 6 3

♥ J 4 2

♦ 9 7 4

♣ 8 6 5

NORTH has 18 points and a 5-card ♥ suit. This is a good hand to open 1♥.

SOUTH has three ♥s which is adequate support. But SOUTH only has 4 points which is not strong enough to respond. So SOUTH passes.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

All Pass

1♥ by North

Lead: ♦3

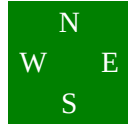
**Board 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 8 2  
 ♥ K 5 4 3  
 ♦ 8 6  
 ♣ 9 8 3 2

♠ A 3  
 ♥ Q 10  
 ♦ Q J 3 2  
 ♣ 10 7 6 5 4



♠ Q J 9 6 4  
 ♥ A 9  
 ♦ K 7 4  
 ♣ K Q J

♠ 10 7 5  
 ♥ J 8 7 6 2  
 ♦ A 10 9 5  
 ♣ A

| <i>West</i> | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|-------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|             |              | 1 ♠         | Pass         |
| 2 ♠         | Pass         | 3 ♠         |              |
| All Pass    |              |             |              |
| 3 ♠ by East |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♣A    |              |             |              |

EAST has 17 points counting 1 extra for the fifth ♠. This is a middle-range hand with five ♠s. So he opens 1 ♠.

WEST only has 7 points, 6 in high cards and one more for the doubleton ♦. But she does have three ♠s, so she can respond 2 ♠.

Since EAST is middle-range, he makes one more try by bidding 3 ♠.

If WEST had 9 or 10 points she would now bid 4 ♠ - but with 7 she passes.

**Board 3**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 3  
 ♥ 9 6  
 ♦ K Q 10 7  
 ♣ A 10 9 3

♠ Q 7 5  
 ♥ K J 7 4  
 ♦ J 9 4 2  
 ♣ J 8



♠ 10  
 ♥ A Q 10 5 2  
 ♦ 8 5 3  
 ♣ K 7 6 2

♠ A J 9 6 4 2  
 ♥ 8 3  
 ♦ A 6  
 ♣ Q 5 4

With 8 points, NORTH is not strong enough to open the bidding.

SOUTH has 13 points, barely meeting the minimum for a 1-opening. Note that the fifth and sixth ♠ each added 1 point to his count. He opens 1 ♠.

Although NORTH passed originally, she must respond to SOUTH's opening bid. Since she has three ♠s she raises to 2 ♠.

In light of NORTH's weak response SOUTH passes.

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              | Pass         | Pass        | 1 ♠          |
| Pass         | 2 ♠          |             |              |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 2 ♠ by South |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♥9     |              |             |              |

**Board 4**

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K  
♥ Q J 8 6 4 2  
♦ K Q 3  
♣ 7 5

♠ 9 8 3 2

♥ A 3

♦ J 6 5 4 2

♣ A 4



♠ J 6 5  
♥ K 10 7 5  
♦ A 8  
♣ 9 8 6 2

♠ Q 10 7 4

♥ 9

♦ 10 9 7

♣ K Q J 10 3

WEST has 17 points and six ♥s. This is a mid-range 1♥ opening bid.

With 9 points, (1 for the doubleton), EAST raises to 2♥.

WEST's hand is worth one more try. He invites with 3♥.

EAST had a strong 2♥ raise, considering that she might have only had 6 points. So she carries on to 4♥.

| West       | North | East | South |
|------------|-------|------|-------|
| 1♥         | Pass  | 2♥   | Pass  |
| 3♥         | Pass  | 4♥   |       |
| All Pass   |       |      |       |
| 4♥ by West |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♣A   |       |      |       |